OBLIQUE TAX INTELLIGENCE

Move to the UAE comparison

United Kingdom to the United Arab Emirates · 2026/27 (6 April 2026 to 5 April 2027)

Estimated annual net gain from moving	Tax saved per year	First year after one-off costs
AED 167,696.64	**AED 287,696.64**	**AED 107,696.64**
5-year total (undiscounted)	Payback on one-off costs	FX used (AED per GBP)
AED 778,483.20	**4.3 months**	**4.9 (indicative 2026-11-06)**

United Kingdom today	United Arab Emirates
Gross income GBP 150,000.00 Income tax + contributions – GBP 58,713.60 Effective rate 39.14% · marginal 45.00% **Net per year GBP 91,286.40** (AED 447,303.36) Net per month GBP 7,607.20	Gross package AED 735,000.00 Personal income tax – AED 0.00 Extra annual living costs – AED 120,000.00 **Net per year AED 615,000.00** Net per month AED 51,250.00 UAE: 0% personal income tax and no social security for expatriate employees.

What to settle before the saving is real

United Kingdom: breaking tax residence
Statutory Residence Test. You are automatically non-resident for a tax year if you spend fewer than 16 days in the UK (having been UK resident in any of the previous three tax years), fewer than 46 days (if not resident in any of those years), or work full-time abroad with fewer than 91 UK days and fewer than 31 UK workdays. Otherwise the sufficient-ties test decides. Split-year treatment can apply in the year you leave.

United Kingdom: breaking tax residence
Temporary non-residence. Leave for fewer than five years and certain gains and income realised while away are taxed when you return.

United Kingdom: breaking tax residence
UK-source income stays UK-taxable. Rental income is the usual one. The UK and the UAE have a double tax treaty.

Residence not yet reviewed
Whether and when you stop being taxable at home is the single biggest assumption in this comparison. Get a residence review before relying on the saving.

Retained home-country connections
Property, business, family or significant days at home can keep you resident or keep home-source income taxable. Do not assume home tax falls to zero.

UAE package assumed equal to current income
Converted at 4.9 AED per GBP (indicative rate as of 2026-11-06). Enter your actual UAE offer for a real comparison.

Cost of living and benefits
The UAE has 5% VAT, no state pension accrual for expatriates, and employer-funded health cover and end-of-service gratuity instead of social insurance. Use the 'additional annual costs' field to reflect housing and schooling.

Working paper: United Kingdom tax computation

Step	Rule	Amount
Gross annual employment income (2026/27 (6 April 2026 to 5 April 2027))		150,000.00

Step	Rule	Amount
Less: Personal Allowance (tapered above GBP 100,000)	gb.pit.personal_allowance	0.00
Taxable income		**150,000.00**
Income tax: 20.0% on GBP 0 to 37,700 37,700 x 20.0%	gb.pit.bands	**7,540.00**
Income tax: 40.0% on GBP 37,700 to 125,140 87,440 x 40.0%	gb.pit.bands	**34,976.00**
Income tax: 45.0% on GBP above 125,140 24,860 x 45.0%	gb.pit.bands	**11,187.00**
Income tax		**53,703.00**
National Insurance (Class 1, 8%)		**3,016.00**
National Insurance (2% above UEL)		**1,994.60**
Total tax and mandatory contributions		**58,713.60**
Net take-home pay		**91,286.40**

Rules applied, review status and sources

gb.pit.personal_allowance — Personal Allowance GBP 12,570, reduced by GBP 1 for every GBP 2 of income above GBP 100,000 (nil from GBP 125,140).
Status: Verified · Source: HMRC

gb.pit.bands — Basic rate 20% on the first GBP 37,700 of taxable income, higher rate 40% to GBP 125,140, additional rate 45% above.
Status: Verified · Source: HMRC

gb.nic.class1 — Employee Class 1 NIC: 8% between the primary threshold GBP 12,570 and the upper earnings limit GBP 50,270, 2% above.
Status: Verified · Source: HMRC National Insurance rates

Assumptions

Recurring figures are held constant for the horizon; no inflation, salary growth, FX movement, investment return or discounting. Origin tax is a full-year, single, employment-income estimate; split-year treatment, exit taxes and retained home-source income are not computed. No tax-residence determination is made. England, Wales or Northern Ireland rates (Scottish bands differ). Employment income only; no benefits in kind, pension contributions or student loan. Class 1 employee National Insurance on a single employment.

Desktop calculator

A desktop estimate from your inputs and the rules shown. Not advice. For your numbers, talk to Oblique Consult. Your inputs are not stored.

For a reviewed position based on your facts, contact Oblique Consult: obliqueconsult.com · info@obliqueconsult.com · +971 50 687 3135

Reproduce this calculation: https://tax.obliqueconsult.com/move_to_uae